



Ancient History Capsule

History ab nhi rahegi Mystery

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INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION

Flourished from 2600 BCE to 1900 BCE

❖ **GEOGRAPHY & SETTLEMENTS**

- Located in the **Indus River Valley** (present-day India and Pakistan)
- Vast and extensive civilization
- **Major cities:-** Harappa, Mohenjodaro, Dholavira, Lothal
- Planned urban centres with **grid-like street layout**
- Sophisticated drainage systems and public wells

❖ **SOCIAL ORGANISATION**

- **Well-structured** society
- Hierarchical system with distinct social classes
- Evidence of a ruling elite and priestly class
- **Skilled artisans, traders, and labourers**
- Evidence of communal living and shared public spaces
- Possible evidence of gender equality and absence of social discrimination

❖ **ARCHITECTURE & CRAFTSMANSHIP**

- Advanced urban planning and architecture
- Use of **standardised bricks** in construction
- **Large public buildings, granaries, and reservoirs**
- Elaborate drainage and sewage systems
- Intricate and well-designed houses with **courtyards**

- Skilled craftsmanship in **pottery, metalwork, jewellery, and figurines**

❖ WRITING SYSTEM & SYMBOLS

- **Indus script**, still undeciphered, **Boustrophedon method of writing**
- Thousands of **short inscriptions** found on **seals and tablets**
- Use of **pictographic** and **abstract symbols**

❖ TRADE & ECONOMY

- Thriving trade networks with **Mesopotamia** and **other regions**
- Presence of seals depicting animals and script, possibly indicating ownership or trade
- Evidence of long-distance trade in precious stones, metals, and goods
- **Agricultural economy** based on **cultivation of wheat, barley, and domestication of animals**
- Craft specialisation and production of **goods for trade**

❖ RELIGION & RITUALS

- **Worship** of **Mother Goddess** and **male deities**
- **Ritual bathing** and religious bathing platforms (**Great Bath**)
- Ritualistic objects and figurines found in **archaeological excavations**
- Possible **worship of trees, animals, and fertility symbols**
- **No temple** like structure found; **belief in Ghosts and Evil forces** (Wore amulets for protection)

❖ DAILY LIFE & SOCIETY

- Well-planned cities with separate residential, commercial, and industrial areas
- Houses with **multiple rooms** and **private bathing** facilities
- Access to public amenities like **wells, public baths, and assembly areas**
- Evidence of an organised system of weights and measures (weights in multiple of 16)
- Evidence of **games, music, and artistic** expression

❖ ECONOMIC ACTIVITIES

- **Agriculture:-** Cultivation of **wheat, barley** (Banawali), **rice** (Lothal and Rangpur), and **cotton**
- **Animal husbandry:-** Domestication of **cattle, sheep, goats,** and **pigs**
- **Craftsmanship:** **Pottery making, metalworking, jewellery making, bead making**
- **Trade and commerce:** Long-distance trade networks, use of **seals** for commercial transactions

❖ EXCAVATED SITES

- **Harappa:-** Located in Pakistan, **well-preserved urban site with public and private structures**
- **Mohenjo-Daro:-** Located in Pakistan, **well-planned city with Great Bath, granaries, and residential areas**
- **Dholavira:-** Located in Gujarat, (India) with impressive water management systems and fortified structures
- **Lothal:-** Located in Gujarat, (India) known for its **dockyard and maritime trade connections**

- **Rakhigarhi :-** Located in **Haryana, (India)** one of the **largest Indus Valley settlements**

❖ DECAY & DECLINE

- Theories on the decline include **ecological factors, floods, or shifts in river courses**
- Possible invasion or internal conflicts leading to the decline
- **Abandonment** of major cities and urban centres

SITE	MAJOR FINDINGS	EXCAVATORS	IMPORTANCE
Mohenjo-daro	➤ Great Bath ➤ large-scale urban planning, ➤ advanced drainage systems, ➤ priest King, ➤ Bronze Dancing Girl	➤ R.D. Banerji ➤ John Marshall ➤ Ernest Mackay	➤ One of the largest cities ➤ showcasing the civilization's urban sophistication and engineering skills
Harappa	➤ Grid-like street patterns ➤ well-built structures ➤ Steatite seals ➤ mother Goddess	➤ Sir John Marshall ➤ Mortimer Wheeler ➤ Rai Bahadur	➤ First site to be excavated ➤ contributed to the initial understanding of the civilization

Lothal	➤ Dockyard ➤ warehouse ➤ complexes ➤ advanced maritime trade ➤ Bead- making workshop ➤ Rice husk	➤ S.R. Rao ➤ J.P. Joshi ➤ Rakhal Das Banerjee	➤ Important port city ➤ evidence of Indus Valley's maritime activities and trade
Dholavira	➤ Large-scale water management systems ➤ three divisions of town ➤ stadium	➤ R.S. Bisht ➤ J.P. Joshi ➤ Ravindra Singh Bisht	➤ Showcased advanced urban planning ➤ extensive water conservation techniques
Kalibangan	➤ Unique fire altars ➤ defensive walls ➤ evidence of plough agriculture	➤ B.B. Lal ➤ A. Ghosh ➤ K.N. Dikshit	➤ Provided insights into the civilization's agricultural practices and urban planning
Rakhigarhi	➤ Extensive urban settlement ➤ cemetery with large number of burials ➤ steatite Dice	➤ Amarendra Nath ➤ Vasant Shinde ➤ R.S. Bisht	➤ Largest known Indus Valley site, ➤ significant in studying the civilization's social structure
Chanhudaro	➤ Planned city layout ➤ bronze and copper artefacts ➤ cylindrical seals	➤ Ernest Mackay ➤ N.G. Majumdar	➤ Demonstrated urban planning and copper metallurgy skills
Rangpur	➤ Unique steatite (soapstone) seals ➤ terracotta figurines	➤ Ghosh ➤ S.P. Gupta	➤ Significance lies in the discovery of distinct seals and artwork

Kot Diji	➤ Fortification walls ➤ specialised pottery ➤ early Harappan culture	➤ G.F. Dales ➤ Ahmed Hasan Dani	Provides insights into the pre-Harappan phase and cultural development
Ropar	➤ Indus Valley script inscriptions ➤ agricultural terraces ➤ dog buried with humans ➤ oval pit burial	➤ Y.D. Sharma ➤ Shikaripur Ranganatha Rao	➤ Important for the discovery of inscribed objects and agricultural practices in the region
Surkotada	➤ Citadel and lower town fortified ➤ pot burial ➤ remains of horse bone	➤ Jagat Pati Joshi	Note: Horse bone is found but IVC people

EARLY VEDIC PERIOD

Estimated from 1500 BCE to 1000 BCE

❖ GEOGRAPHY & SETTLEMENTS

- Early Vedic Period marks the migration of **Indo-Aryans** into the **Indian subcontinent**
- Settlements primarily in the **north-western** region of the Indian subcontinent
- **Major regions:** **Sapta-Sindhu** (Seven Rivers) region
- Settlements along the banks of rivers like the **Indus**, **Sarasvati**.

❖ SOCIETY & SOCIAL STRUCTURE

- Tribal society based on **kinship** and **clans**
- Tribal units called "**Janas**" or "**Jatis**"
- **Raja** (**king**) as the central authority
- **Rajan** (**chief**) as the leader of the tribe
- Presence of **warrior class** (**Kshatriyas**), **priests** (**Brahmins**), and **common people** (**Vaishyas**)
- Social hierarchy based on birth (**varna system**) - **Brahmins**, **Kshatriyas**, **Vaishyas**, **Shudras**

❖ RELIGION & RITUALS

- Polytheistic religion
- Worship of **natural forces** and **deities** (**devas**)
- **Agni** (**fire god**), **Indra** (**thunder god**), **Varuna** (**god of cosmic order**), and others revered
- Performance of **yajnas** (**ritual sacrifices**) and prayers
- Importance of **hymns and prayers** (**Rigveda**)
- Role of Brahmins as priests and custodians of religious rituals

❖ LITERATURE & ORAL TRADITION

- Preservation of knowledge through oral transmission
- **Rigveda** - **Oldest Vedic text, collection of hymns**
- Samaveda, Yajurveda, Atharvaveda - **Other Vedic texts**
- Rich **poetic and metaphoric** language
- Composed and recited by **Rishis** (**sages**)

❖ ECONOMY & LIVELIHOOD

- **Pastoral and agricultural** economy

- Cattle rearing and agriculture (wheat, barley, rice, pulses)
- Importance of cattle wealth (go-dhana)
- Barter system for exchange of goods
- No known coinage system during this period

❖ POLITICAL SYSTEM & GOVERNANCE

- Tribal chief (Rajan) as the political authority
- Assembly of tribes (Sabha) for decision-making
- Importance of counsel (Purohita) for advice to the king
- Emergence of kingdoms (Mahajanapadas) in later Vedic period

❖ SETTLEMENTS & DWELLINGS

- Semi-nomadic lifestyle in the early phase
- Later settled agricultural communities (grame)
- Simple houses made of wood, reeds, and thatch
- Settlements fortified with wooden palisades
- Development of villages (grama) and towns (nigama) over time

❖ TECHNOLOGY & SKILLS

- Knowledge of metal working (copper, bronze)
- Horse-drawn chariots used in warfare
- Skill in agriculture and irrigation techniques
- Weaving, pottery, and carpentry skills
- Use of horse and oxen for transportation and ploughing

❖ DECLINE & TRANSITION

- Gradual transition to the later Vedic period

- **Socio-political changes** with the emergence of **kingdoms**
- Transition from **pastoral** to **settled** agricultural communities
- Transformation in **religious practices and rituals**

LATER VEDIC AGE

Estimated from **1000 BCE** to **600 BCE**

❖ **GEOGRAPHY & SETTLEMENTS**

- Continuation of **Indo-Aryan** settlements in the **Indian subcontinent**
- Expansion towards the **Gangetic plains and eastern regions**
- **Major regions:-** Gangetic plains (**Panchala, Kuru, Kosala, Videha**), Eastern regions (**Anga, Magadha**)
- Settlements along the banks of rivers like the **Ganges, Yamuna, and Sarayu**

❖ **SOCIETY & SOCIAL STRUCTURE**

- Evolution of **complex social** structure and **varna** system
- **Varna system:-** **Brahmins** (priestly class), **Kshatriyas** (warrior/administrative class), **Vaishyas** (merchant/agricultural class), **Shudras** (labourer/servant class)
- Emergence of **new social groups**, including skilled **artisans and traders (shreshthi)**
- Development of **urban centres** and **fortified cities**
- Presence of powerful monarchies and ruling dynasties

❖ **RELIGION & RITUALS**

- Continuation of polytheistic religion

- Vedic deities revered, but new deities introduced
- **Prajapati (creator god)**, **Rudra (destructive god)**, **Vishnu (preserving god)**, and **others worshipped**; Rigvedic gods lost their prominence
- Rituals and sacrifices (**yajnas**) held with increased complexity
- **Emergence of ritual manuals (Brahmanas)** to guide religious practices
- Role of Brahmins as custodians of rituals and religious knowledge

❖ LITERATURE & SCHOLARSHIP

- Compilation and preservation of **Vedic texts**
- **Brahmanas**: Prose texts explaining rituals and symbolic interpretations
- **Aranyakas**: Forest treatises with philosophical and meditative content
- **Upanishads**: Philosophical texts exploring concepts of the self, reality, and liberation (moksha)
- Emergence of early philosophical and speculative thought

❖ ECONOMY & LIVELIHOOD

- Transition to settled **agricultural communities**
- Expansion of agricultural practices, including **rice cultivation**
- **Cattle wealth** and **agriculture** continued to be important
- Increased trade and commerce, with organised guilds (srenis)
- **Barter system continued**, with the introduction of coins (**punch-marked coins**) in later phase

❖ POLITICAL SYSTEM & GOVERNANCE

- Emergence of powerful monarchies (**Mahajanapadas**)
- **Kingship** based on **hereditary** succession
- **Sabha** (**council of elders**) and **Samiti** (**assembly of people**) for decision-making
- Sabha becoming more **aristocratic** in nature
- Rise of powerful monarchies like **Magadha** under the **Nandas** and **Mauryas**

❖ SETTLEMENTS & URBANIZATION

- Development of **fortified cities** and **urban centres**
- Planning and construction of cities with well-defined roads and public spaces
- Presence of **royal palaces**, **administrative buildings**, and **public marketplaces**
- Increased specialisation in **crafts and trade**
- Shift towards urban lifestyle and growth of urban populations

❖ TECHNOLOGY & SKILLS

- Advancements in **iron** technology, leading to **the Iron Age**
- **Iron tools and weapons** used in **agriculture** and **warfare**
- Continued expertise in **metalworking**, including **bronze** and **copper**
- Development of urban infrastructure like water reservoirs and canals
- Skill in **pottery**, **weaving**, **carpentry**, and other crafts

❖ LITERARY WORKS & PHILOSOPHICAL THOUGHT

- Compilation and preservation of the **Vedic texts**

- Emergence of **early philosophical** and speculative thought
- Upanishads exploring concepts of **Brahman, Atman, and liberation (moksha)**
- Early seeds of philosophical systems like **Vedanta** and **Sankhya**

❖ DECLINE & TRANSITION

- Gradual transition to the **post-Vedic** period and the **rise of new religions and philosophies**
- **Decline of Vedic** rituals and the emergence of alternative religious practices
- **Rise of Jainism and Buddhism** challenging traditional Vedic beliefs
- Emergence of regional states and new dynasties
- Transformation of the **political, social, and religious landscape**

BUDDHISM

- Founded by **Gautama Buddha** in the **6th century BCE**

❖ LIFE OF GAUTAMA BUDDHA & EARLY BUDDHIST TEACHINGS

- **Gautama Buddha's birth** in **Lumbini**, Nepal (563 BCE)
- His renunciation of worldly life and search for **enlightenment**
- **Enlightenment** under the **Bodhi tree in Bodh Gaya**
- **Sermon** of the **First Turning** of **the Wheel of Dharma** in **Sarnath**

- **Four Noble Truths:** Existence of suffering, its cause, cessation, and the Eightfold Path
- **Middle Way:** Avoidance of extremes and moderation in all aspects of life
- Emphasis on mindfulness, compassion, and non-attachment

❖ THREE JEWELS & CORE TEACHINGS

- **Three Jewels (Triple Gem):** Buddha, Dharma, Sangha
- Buddha as the enlightened teacher and guide
- Dharma as the teachings and path to liberation
- Sangha as the monastic community and spiritual support system
- **Core teachings:** Four Noble Truths, Eightfold Path, and Three Marks of Existence

❖ BUDDHIST SCHISMS & COUNCILS

1. **First Buddhist Council (483 BCE):** Compilation of Buddha's teachings,
Rules of Monastic order: Sutta Pitaka & Vinay Pitaka (Tripitaka), Rajgir
2. **Second Buddhist Council (383 BCE):** Debate over monastic discipline, Vaishali
3. **Third Buddhist Council (250 BCE):** Compilation of Abhidhamma (philosophical texts), Patliputra
4. **Fourth Buddhist Council (78 AD):** Kundalvan, Kashmir
 - Mahasanghika and Sthaviravada schism: Differences in monastic practices and doctrines
 - Emergence of different Buddhist schools: Theravada, Mahayana, Vajrayana, Zen

❖ EIGHTFOLD PATH OF BUDDHA

- **Right View:** Understanding the nature of reality and the Four Noble Truths
- **Right Intention:** Cultivating wholesome and compassionate intentions
- **Right Speech:** Speaking truthfully, kindly, and avoiding harmful speech
- **Right Action:** Engaging in ethical conduct and avoiding harm to oneself and others
- **Right Livelihood:** Pursuing a livelihood that is honest and non-harming
- **Right Effort:** Cultivating wholesome qualities and abandoning unwholesome ones
- **Right Mindfulness:** Being present, aware, and attentive to the present moment
- **Right Concentration:** Cultivating focused and tranquil states of mind through meditation

❖ BUDDHIST LITERATURE

- **Tripitaka (Pali Canon):** Collection of Buddha's discourses (Sutta), Vinaya (monastic rules), and Abhidhamma (philosophical analysis)
- **Mahayana Sutras:** Vast collection of scriptures emphasising compassion and bodhisattva ideal
- **Tibetan Buddhist Texts:** Kangyur (translated words of the Buddha) and Tengyur (commentaries by Indian and Tibetan scholars)
- **Zen Teachings:** Koans, dialogues, and writings of Zen masters

- **Jataka Tales:** Stories of Buddha's previous lives and moral lessons
- Commentaries and Treatises by Buddhist scholars (e.g., Nagarjuna, Vasubandhu, Dogen)

❖ BUDDHIST PRACTICES & RITUALS

- **Meditation (Dhyana):** Mindfulness, concentration, and insight practices
- Observance of moral precepts (e.g., non-violence, honesty, compassion)

❖ BUDDHIST MONASTIC COMMUNITY

- **Monastic Sangha:** Community of monks (bhikkhus) and nuns (bhikkhunis)
- Importance of monastic discipline (Vinaya)
- Roles of monastics in preserving and spreading Buddhist teachings
- Monastic education and training in Buddhist scriptures and practices

❖ SPREAD OF BUDDHISM & BUDDHIST ART

- **Early spread** to Northern India, Sri Lanka, Southeast Asia, and Central Asia
- **Ashoka's patronage and propagation of Buddhism in ancient India**
- Silk Road trade route facilitating the spread to China, Korea, and Japan

- **Buddhist art:** Sculptures, paintings, and architectural monuments (stupas, viharas)
- **Symbolism in Buddhist art** (e.g., lotus, Buddha statues, wheel of Dharma)

ASPECT/EVENT	SYMBOL
Buddha's Footprints	The footprint of the Buddha, symbolizing his physical presence and spiritual guidance.
Dhamma Wheel	A wheel with eight spokes, representing the Noble Eightfold Path and the Buddha's teachings (Dhamma).
Bodhi Tree	A tree under which the Buddha attained enlightenment. It symbolises spiritual awakening and enlightenment.

Stupa	A dome-shaped structure containing relics or remains of the Buddha or other revered figures. Symbolises the Buddha's final passing into Nirvana.
Lotus Flower	The lotus represents purity, enlightenment, and the potential to rise above suffering, as it grows from muddy waters but remains pristine.
Dharmachakra	The wheel of Dhamma, symbolising the Buddha's first sermon and the turning of the wheel of truth. Represents the path to liberation.
Buddha's Three Gestures	The hand gestures of the Buddha (mudras) symbolize various moments in his life, such as teaching, meditation, and reassurance.

Offering Bowl	Represents offerings made by devotees to the Buddha and the Sangha, signifying generosity and devotion.
Alms Bowl	The begging bowl used by Buddhist monks during alms rounds. Signifies renunciation and reliance on the community for sustenance.
Dhammapada (Buddhist Text)	The Dhammapada is a revered text containing the teachings and sayings of the Buddha, used as a guiding principle for practitioners.

Aspect	Mahayana Buddhism	Hinayana Buddhism (Theravada)
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Definition	Mahayana means "Great Vehicle"	Hinayana means "Lesser Vehicle" or "Small Vehicle"
Goal	Emphasis on attaining Buddhahood for all beings	Focus on personal enlightenment (Arhatship)
Buddhas	Recognizes multiple Buddhas and Bodhisattvas	Focus on Gautama Buddha as the primary Buddha
Bodhisattvas	Bodhisattvas are highly revered and play an active role in helping others achieve enlightenment	Less emphasis on Bodhisattvas and their role

Compassion	Emphasis on universal compassion and altruism	Compassion is valued, but less emphasis on universal compassion
Scriptures	Expanded canon with additional Mahayana Sutras	Follows the Pali Canon (Tipitaka)
Enlightenment Path	Emphasis on the Bodhisattva path, striving to benefit all sentient beings	Focus on individual self-liberation and personal development
Language of Scriptures	Some Mahayana scriptures are in Sanskrit	Theravada scriptures are in Pali
Monastic Rules	Slightly more flexible monastic rules	Strict adherence to monastic rules

Followers	Predominant in East Asian countries (e.g., China, Japan, Korea)	Predominant in Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand, Cambodia, Laos
View of Lay Practitioners	Lay practitioners can actively participate in the Bodhisattva path	Lay practitioners are encouraged to support the monastic Sangha

JAINISM

Founded by **Lord Mahavira** in the **6th century BCE**

❖ LIFE OF LORD MAHAVIRA & JAIN TENETS

- Lord **Mahavira's** birth in **Kundagrama** (Vaishali, present-day Bihar, India) in 599 BCE
- **Renunciation** and **spiritual** pursuit at the age of 30
- Attainment of **Kevala Jnana** (omniscience) after **12 years of intense meditation**
- **Sermon of the First Discourse** (**Sutrakritanga**) at **Jambhiyavalli**
- **Jain principles**: **Non-violence** (ahimsa), **truthfulness** (satya), **non-stealing** (asteya), **celibacy** (brahmacharya), and **non-**

possessiveness (aparigraha); **4 principles** derived from earlier Tirthankara but Celibacy was added to the list by **Mahavira**.

- Belief in the cycle of birth, death, and rebirth (**samsara**) and the liberation of the soul (**moksha**)

❖ THREE JEWELS & FUNDAMENTAL TEACHINGS

- **Three Jewels** (Ratnatraya): **Right faith** (Samyak Darshan), **right knowledge** (Samyak Jnana), and **right conduct** (Samyak Charitra)
- **Five Vows** (Mahavratas): **Ahimsa** (non-violence), **Satya** (truth), **Asteya** (non-stealing), **Brahmacharya** (celibacy), and **Aparigraha** (non-attachment)
- **Doctrine of Karma**: Belief in the accumulation of karma through actions and its influence on **future rebirths**
- **Jain ethics**: Compassion towards all living beings, vegetarianism, and environmental stewardship

❖ JAIN COSMOLOGY & PHILOSOPHY

- Belief in an **eternal** and **uncreated universe** with cycles of time
- **Six substances** (dravyas): **Jiva** (soul), **Ajiva** (non-living matter), **Punya** (merit), **Papa** (demerit), **Asrava** (influx of karma), and **Samvara** (cessation of karma)
- **Theory of karma**: Different types of karma determining one's experiences and destiny

- Doctrine of non-absolutism (**Anekantavada**) and relativity of truth
- **Syadvada**: Theory of multiple perspectives and non-one-sidedness

❖ FIVE GREAT VOWS OF JAIN MONKS & NUNS

- **Monastic Sangha**: Ascetic community of monks (Sadhus) and nuns (Sadhwis)
- **Five Great Vows (Mahavratas)**: Ahimsa (non-violence), Satya (truth), Asteya (non-stealing), Brahmacharya (celibacy), and Aparigraha (non-attachment)
- Strict adherence to ascetic lifestyle, self-discipline, and detachment from worldly attachments
- Practices of fasting, meditation, self-control, and study of Jain scriptures (Agamas)

❖ JAIN SCRIPTURES & LITERATURE

- **Agamas**: Canonical scriptures containing the teachings of Lord Mahavira
- **Angas**: Commentaries and explanations on the Agamas
- **Tattvartha Sutra**: Jain philosophical text by Acharya Umaswati
- Prakrit and Sanskrit texts by Jain scholars and philosophers
- **Jain poetry and literature**: Writings by Jain poets and scholars

❖ JAIN SYMBOLS & ICONOGRAPHY

- **Jain emblem**: Ahimsa (hand with a raised palm)

- **Tirthankara images and statues:** Depicting enlightened beings in various postures (asanas)
- **Symbolism of Jain art:** Serene expressions, non-violence, auspicious symbols (swastika), and Jain cosmology

❖ JAIN CONTRIBUTIONS & IMPACT

- Influence on Indian philosophy, ethics, and religious practices
- Promotion of **non-violence**, compassion, and environmental sustainability

ASPECT	SVETAMBAR	DIGAMBAR
 Clothing	White-clad monks and nuns wear white clothes.	Sky-clad (naked) monks believe in the practice of nudity as a form of austerity. Nuns wear white clothes.
Scriptures	Accept a larger set of Jain scriptures, including texts	Accept a smaller set of Jain scriptures, written only in Ardhamagadhi.

	written in Ardhamagadhi and other languages.	
Belief in Female Monks	Allow the ordination of female monks (sadhvis).	Do not believe in the ordination of female monks, considering it impossible due to the requirement of nudity.
Sect Origin	Originated from the teachings of Sthulabhadra, after the Jain Council of Vallabhi (3rd century CE).	Claim to follow the original teachings of Lord Mahavira and believe that their sect predates the Svetambar tradition.
Art and Images	Allow the creation and worship of images of Tirthankaras.	Reject the use of images for worship, as they believe Lord Mahavira forbade it.

Sect Population	More numerous and widespread.	Smaller in numbers and mainly found in South India.
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<u>EVENT</u>	<u>BUDDHA</u>	<u>MAHAVIRA</u>
Place of Birth	Lumbini, present-day Nepal	Kundagrama (Vaishali), India
First Sermon	Sarnath, present-day Uttar Pradesh, India	Magadha, present-day Bihar, India
Death	Kushinagar, present-day Uttar Pradesh, India	Pawapuri, present-day Bihar, India

Philosophy	Buddhism	Jainism
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16 MAHAJANAPADAS

Mahajanapada	Capital	Present-day	Important City	Important Ruler	River
Anga	Champa	Bhagalpur, Bihar	Champa	Unknown	Ganga
Assaka/Asmaka	Potana/Potali	Maharashtra and Telangana	Potana/Potali	Unknown	Godavari

Avanti/Malava	Ujjayini/ Mahishmati	Western Madhya Pradesh	Ujjayini	Chanda Pradyota Mahasena	Narmada
Chedi/Soyambaka	Shuktimati	Bundelkhand region, Uttar Pradesh	Shuktimati	Shishupala	Yamuna
Gandhara/Taksha shila	Taxila	Pakistan and Afghanistan	Taxila	Ambhi (Porus)	Indus
Kamboja/Kumbha	Rajapura	Parts of Afghanistan, Pakistan, and Punjab	Rajapura	Unknown	Swat
Kashi/Varanasi	Varanasi/Kashi	Uttar Pradesh	Varanasi/Kas hi	Prasenajit	Ganga

Kaushambi/Kosambi	Kausambi	Allahabad, Uttar Pradesh	Kausambi	Udayana	Yamuna
Kuru/Indo-Aryan	Hastinapura	Haryana and Delhi	Hastinapura	Sudas	Yamuna
Magadha	Rajagriha/Pataliputra	Bihar	Rajagriha, Pataliputra	Bimbisara, Ajatashatru	Ganga
Matsya/Virat Nagari	Virat Nagari	Alwar, Rajasthan	Virat Nagari	Unknown	Chambal
Panchala/Ahichatra	Ahichatra/Kampilya	Uttarakhand and Uttar Pradesh	Ahichatra, Kampilya	Chetaka, Drupada	Ganga
Surasena/Mathura	Mathura	Uttar Pradesh	Mathura	Kamsa	Yamuna

Vatsa/Kaushambi	Kaushambi	Uttar Pradesh	Kaushambi	Udayana	Yamuna
Vrishni/Dwarka	Dwarka	Gujarat	Dwarka	Krishna	Arabian Sea

MAGADHA DYNASTY

- **Magadha Dynasty** was one of the most powerful dynasties in ancient India.

❖ HARYANKA DYNASTY (600 BCE - 413 BCE)

- Founded by **Bimbisara**, who expanded Magadha's territory and made **Rajagriha** the capital.

❖ BIMBISARA

- Expanded Magadha's territory through conquest and alliances.
- Established **Rajagriha** as the capital.
- Became a patron of **Gautama Buddha**.
- First ruler to be **killed by his son** for throne
- Annexed **Anga** to avenge his Father's defeat.
- First king to have a standing Army

❖ AJATASHATRU:

- Further expanded Magadha's territory.

- Conquered the city of **Vaishali** and engaged in wars with **Kosala**.
- Constructed a fortress at **Pataliputra**.
- Killed **his father** for throne
- Developed various Military Instruments; **Mahashilakantaka**, and **Rathmoosala**

❖ UDAYIN

- Shifted Capital from Rajagriha to Pataliputra
- Nagadashaka- Last Haryanka Ruler

❖ SHISHUNAGA DYNASTY (412 BCE - 345 BCE)

- Founded by **Shishunaga** after overthrowing the **Haryanka** dynasty.

❖ SHISHUNAGA:

- Shifted the capital from **Pataliputra** to **Vaishali**.
- **First Brahmin ruler** of Magadha Empire
- **Defeated** Pradyota Dynasty of Avanti

❖ KALASHOKA

- Also known as **Kakarvarna** (a/c to **Puranas**)
- Shifted **capital** from **Vaishali** to **Patliputra**
- **Second Buddhist** Council during his Reign

❖ NANDA DYNASTY (345 BCE - 321 BCE)

- Founded by Mahapadma Nanda after overthrowing the Shishunaga dynasty.

❖ Mahapadma Nanda:

- took the title of **Ekarat**

- **Conquered** Panchala, Kuru, Asmaka, Surasena
- **Effective Taxation system** and **maintained a large Army**
- Nanda dynasty witnessed a period of consolidation and centralization of power.

❖ Dhana Nanda:

- **Last ruler of the Nanda dynasty.**
- **Pataliputra** remained **the capital and a major economic and political centre.**
- Overthrown by Chandragupta Maurya

❖ MAURYA DYNASTY (321 BCE - 185 BCE)

- ✚ Founded by **Chandragupta Maurya**, who overthrew the **Nanda dynasty** with the help of **Chanakya**

❖ Chandragupta Maurya:

- Expanded the **Mauryan Empire** through military campaigns.
- A/c to Jain texts, **Chandragupta Maurya** adopted Jainism and went to Shravana Belgola with Bhadrabahu and committed Sallekhana (death by slow Starvation)
- Defeated **Selcus Nicator** and married **his Daughter Helena**

❖ Bindusara

- Also known as **Amitrochates** (slayer of enemies) or **Amitraghat.**
- **Antiochus I (Syrian King)** sent Deimachus as an ambassador to his court.
- Joined **Ajivika Sect**
- **Taranath** (a Tibetan Monk) states that he won **16 states**
- Appointed **Ashoka Governor of Ujjain and Taxila**

❖ Ashoka the Great:

- Transformed the empire with his **Buddhist teachings and principles of Dhamma**.
- **Pataliputra continued** as the capital, known for its grandeur and administration.
- **Maurya dynasty** witnessed significant advancements in **governance and infrastructure**.
- Initiated military campaigns to expand the empire.
- After the **Battle of Kalinga**, he renounced **violence and embraced Buddhism**.
- **Promoted welfare activities**, including the construction of hospitals and public works.

❖ CULTURAL & SOCIAL HISTORY

- **Spread of Buddhism:** Ashoka played a pivotal role in the propagation of Buddhism within and beyond India.
- Sent missionaries to various regions to spread the teachings of Buddhism.
- Built stupas and monasteries as centres of Buddhist learning and worship.
- **Patronage of Art & Architecture:** Mauryan rulers were patrons of art and architecture.
- Construction of grand structures like the Great Stupa at Sanchi and the Ashokan Pillars.
- **Society & Administration:** The Mauryan Empire had a well-organised administrative system.

- Divisions into provinces (Mahajanapadas) and districts (Janapadas) for effective governance.
- Officials such as Mahamatyas and Rajukas supervised the administration.

❖ ADMINISTRATION:

- **Prime Minister (Mahamatra):** Assisted the king in governance and decision-making.
- **Chief Treasurer (Samaharta):** Managed the empire's finances.
- **Chief Justice (Maha Dandanayaka):** Ensured justice and maintained law and order.
- **Superintendent of Public Works (Sannidhata):** Overlooked construction and maintenance of public infrastructure.

❖ ARCHAEOLOGICAL SOURCES:

- **Ashokan Edicts:** Inscriptions on pillars and rocks, providing insights into governance, policies, and religious principles.
- **Sanchi Stupa:** A magnificent Buddhist monument, showcasing Mauryan architectural style.
- **Excavations at Pataliputra:** Unearthed ruins of the Mauryan capital, providing insights into urban planning and lifestyle.

❖ ECONOMIC HISTORY

- **Trade & Commerce:** The Mauryan Empire was known for its flourishing trade networks.
- Trade routes connected India with the Mediterranean region and Southeast Asia.
- **Pataliputra**, the capital, served as a major trading centre.

- **Agriculture:** Agriculture was the backbone of **the Mauryan economy**.
- **Irrigation systems** were developed, contributing to increased agricultural productivity.

❖ RELIGIOUS HISTORY

- **Ashoka's Policy of Dhamma:** Ashoka embraced Buddhism and promoted a policy of Dhamma (righteousness).
- Encouraged moral conduct, **non-violence**, and respect for all religions.
- Edicts were inscribed on pillars and rocks, propagating Dhamma and outlining ethical principles.
- **Ashokan Edicts:** Ashoka's edicts were inscribed in various parts of the empire.
- They provided insights into Ashoka's governance, social policies, and religious tolerance.

❖ DECLINE OF THE MAURYAN EMPIRE

- **Factors Leading to Decline:**
- **Weak Successors:** Weak rulers and succession disputes weakened the empire.
- **Regional Revolts:** Provinces started asserting independence, leading to fragmentation.
- **Economic Drain:** Costly military campaigns and bureaucratic expenses strained the treasury.

- **External Invasions:** Foreign invasions by the Greeks, Sakas, and Parthians destabilised the empire.

<u>Edict Number</u>	<u>Description</u>	<u>Key Points</u>
Major Rock Edict I	Prohibition of animal sacrifice, especially during festive seasons.	Emphasises non-violence and compassion towards animals.
Major Rock Edict II	Medical treatment of humans and animals, planting of fruits, medicinal herbs, and digging of wells. Mentions the Pandyas,	Encourages healthcare, agricultural development, and mentions southern regions of the empire.

	Satyapuras, and Keralaputras of South India.	
Major Rock Edict III	Generosity to Brahmins. About Yuktas, Pradeshikas, and Rajukas who spread Dhamma every five years.	Promotes generosity and the dissemination of Dhamma through appointed officials.
Major Rock Edict IV	Dhammaghosha (sound of Dhamma/righteousness) over Bherighosha (sound of war). King Ashoka's duty.	Prioritizes Dhamma (righteousness) over war and emphasises the king's sense of duty.
Major Rock Edict V	About Dhammamahamatras and treating slaves right. A cadre of officials appointed to spread Dhamma.	Establishes Dhamma officials responsible for promoting Dhamma

		and ensures fair treatment of slaves.
Major Rock Edict VI	King's desire to know about his people's conditions and welfare measures.	Demonstrates Ashoka's concern for the well-being of his subjects and the implementation of welfare measures.
Major Rock Edict VII	Tolerance towards religions among all sects and welfare measures for the public.	Encourages religious tolerance and welfare initiatives, not only in his kingdom but also in neighbouring regions.

Major Rock Edict VIII	Ashoka's first Dhamma Yatra to Bodh Gaya and the Bodhi tree. Importance of Dhamma tours.	Highlights the significance of Ashoka's religious pilgrimage and the value of Dhamma tours.
Major Rock Edict IX	Condemns popular ceremonies and stresses moral conduct.	Discourages extravagant ceremonies and emphasises the importance of moral behaviour.
Major Rock Edict X	Disapproves of the individual's desire for fame and glory and stresses on Dhamma.	Encourages humility and promotes the pursuit of Dhamma over personal ambition.

Major Rock Edict XI	Dhamma as the best policy, respect for elders, and concern for slaves and servants.	Advocates Dhamma as a guiding principle, respect for elders, and compassionate treatment of slaves and servants.
Major Rock Edict XII	Mentions Mahamattas in charge of women's welfare and tolerance towards others' dhamma.	Acknowledges officials responsible for women's welfare and reiterates religious tolerance towards diverse beliefs.
Major Rock Edict XIII	Mentions victory over Kalinga and Ashoka's Dhamma victory over Greek Kings.	Reflects on the brutal Kalinga War, Ashoka's remorse, and his conversion to Buddhism. Mentions interactions

		with Greek kings and regional rulers.
Major Rock Edict XIV	Purpose of rock edicts.	Summarises the intent and significance of the rock edicts in spreading Dhamma and moral principles throughout the empire.

❖ There are only 4 places where **Ashoka** has used his name

1. Maski
2. Brahmagiri (Karnataka)
3. Gujjara (MP)
4. Nettur (AP)

❖ IMPORTANT EDICTS AND INSCRIPTION OF ASHOKA

Edict/Inscription	Remarks
Allahabad – Kosam/Queens Edict/Kausambi or Schism Edict	Ashoka urges the Sangha members to avoid causing divisions. It also contains Samudragupta's inscription.
Kandahar Inscription	Famous bilingual edict in Greek and Aramaic.
Kalinga Edicts (Bhauri and Jaugada)	Mentions the phrase 'All men are my children.'
Sannati Inscription (Karnataka)	Site of all 14 major rock edicts and two separate Kalinga edicts.

Rummindei Inscription (Nepal)	Mentions exemption from bali and reduced taxes for Lumbini, the birthplace of Buddha.
Girnar Rock Inscription of Rudradaman (Kathiawar)	Mentions the Sudarshan lake constructed during Chandragupta Maurya's reign.
Minor Rock Edict 1	Indicates Ashoka's gradual turn towards Buddhism after 2.5 years in power.
Minor Rock Edict 3	Ashoka expresses his deep faith in the Buddha, dhamma, and Sangha and recommends Buddhist texts for monks.
Inscriptions at Shahbazgarhi and Mansehra	Written in Kharosthi script.

❖ Ashoka's Contemporary King

1. Antiochus II - Syria

2. Plotemy II - Egypt
3. Antigonos- Macedonia
4. Magas- Cyrene/ Cyrenaica

❖ POST-MAURYAN DYNASTIES (185 BCE - 321 CE)

- After the **decline** of the Mauryan Empire, Magadha saw the rise of **several smaller dynasties**.

❖ Shunga Dynasty (185 BCE - 72 BCE):

- **Pushyamitra Shunga** established the dynasty.
- Followed Brahminism
- Important Rulers:

❖ **Bhagavata**

- During his reign Heliodorus (Greek ambassador of Antialcidas) erected Besnagar Pillar (Garuda Pillar)

❖ **Vasumitra**

- **Defeated** Greek king Menander
- Conversation between **Menander and Nagsen** is compiled into a book "**Milindapanha**"

❖ **Devbhuti**

- A/c to Harshacharita, Devbhuti was murdered on the instructions of Vasudeva.

❖ Kanva Dynasty (73 BCE - 28 BCE)

- **Established by Vasudeva Kanva after the fall of the Shungas**

- Probably the **descendents of Rishi Kanva**
- Simuka (Satvahana) overthrew **last ruler Susharman**

❖ SATAVAHANAS

- Founded by **Simuka**
- Capital- **Pratistanpura** (Near Godavari bank); **later shifted to Amaravati**
- As known as **Andhras** a/c to **Puranas** but this name **doesn't** appear in Satavahana inscription.
- **Gautamiputra Satakarni** was a powerful ruler; the Nashik inscription mentions their achievement.
- **Junagarh** inscription mentions that **Vashishthiputra Pulumavi** married the daughter of **Rudradaman I.**
- **Satavahanas** along with **Ikshvakus** were patrons of Amravati school of Art.

❖ INDO- GREEKS

Construction of Great Wall of China; Scythians were pushed back; moved towards neighbouring Parthians and Greeks; Greeks invaded India.

- first to introduce **Gold coin in India**
- Introduced Hellenistic art in the **north-west** frontier of India

❖ SAKAS/ SCYTHIANS

- replaced **Indo- Greeks** and controlled large parts of **India & Afghanistan**

- Five Branches of the Shakas

1. Afghanistan
2. Punjab (**Capital- Taxila**)
3. Mathura
4. Western India (Kshatrapas)- **ruled until the 4th century AD.**

5. Upper Deccan region.

- **Moga/ Moa/ Maues** - first Saka king in India

Two important line of **Kshatrapas** rulers are:

1. The **Kshaharatas**: Important ruler- **Nahapana**
2. The **Kardamakas**: Important ruler- **Rudradaman I**

❖ Rudradaman I

- **Repaired Sudarshan Lake**
- **Junagarh inscriptions and Girnar inscription**

❖ Parthians

- Originally belonged to **Iran**; occupied a smaller portion of **north-western India**.
- Most famous ruler- **Gondophernes**; during his reign St. Thomas

❖ KUSHANS

- Also known as **Yuechis/ Yuexhi** or **Tocharians**
- **Yuechi** tribe was divided into **5 clans** out of which **Kushans** came from **Steppes of North Central India**
- settled in **lower Indus basin** and **parts of Gangetic basin**
- **Kadphises I/ Kujula Kadphises** laid the foundation of **Kushan Empire**
- **Wima Kadphises II/ Vima Kadphises** succeeded him
- He issued large number of **Gold coins**
- Most Popular King- **Kanishka**

❖ Kanishka

- Issued number of **gold coins** with high **metallic purity**

- **Purushapura/ Peshawar was first capital**
- **Mathura** was the **second capital**
- Took the title of **Devputra**
- **Rabatak** Inscription (Afghanistan) give information about his rule
- controlled Silk route
- gave patronage to Buddhism
- Vasudeva was **the last king of the dynasty**

❖ Impact of Central Asian Contacts

- **Shakas and Kushans** didn't have their own script or any organised religion, so they adopted these from India
- In **Cavalry, Shakas and kushans** used toe stirrups, reins, and saddles.
- Introduced turban, tunics, trousers, and heavy long coat. They also **used cap, helmet, and boots**
- **Kushans** were the **first** rulers **in India** to **issue gold coins** on a large numbers
- Their rule also saw the beginning of Feudatory organisation
- **Kushans** adopted Pompous titles; to legitimise their royal authority and strengthen the idea of the divine origin of Kingship
- **Kushans** **introduced the Satrap System**, which saw hereditary dual rule (father & son jointly ruled at same time).
- led to the rise of several schools of **art of Gandhara** and **Mathura School of Art**.

❖ Gandhara/ Greco- Roman School of Art

- developed during the **first** century AD.
- **Famous for the portrayal of Buddha** in a spiritual state, eyes half- closed in meditation

❖ Mathura School of Art

- developed during the **Shunga** period; reached its zenith during the **Gupta period**.
- **Red sandstone was primarily used**
- At Sanchi, Bharhut, Gaya, Buddha was depicted as a symbol of either two footprints or wheels.

❖ Sangam Age

- -South of Krishna River, three Kingdoms existed: **Pandyas, Cholas, and Cheras**.
- Sangam= meeting point of Tamil Poets
- **Three Sangams** held in South India:
 1. **First Sangam** at Old Madurai (believed that Gods & legendary sage attained it; no literary sources available)
 2. **Second Sangam** - Kapatpuram/ Kapadapuram (large number of poets attained this; Tolkappiyam- only book available)
 3. **Third Sangam** - Madurai

❖ Sources for Sangam Age

1. Sangam Literature
2. Ashokan Inscriptions
3. Megasthenes

❖ CHERAS

- Also known as Kerala Putras
- Present day Kerala and part of Tamil Nadu

- **Important Kings**- Nedunjeral Adan (AKA Adhiraja), Senguttuvan

❖ Senguttuvan

- **AKA Red Chera**
- Introduced **Pattini cult**
- His brother **Ilango Adigal** wrote “**Silappatikaram**”, and Adigal adopted **Jainism**.

❖ CHOLAS

- Present day **Tirunchi district** (Southern Andhra)
- around **2nd century BC**, **Elara, chola ruler, conquered Sri Lanka and ruled for 50 years.**
- **Capital** from **Uraiyyur** to **Puhar** was shifted by Karikala.
- **Karikala** founded Puhar (Kaveripattanam)
- **Karikala** defeated a confederacy of **Cheras and Pandyas** in the Battle of Venni
- **cholas** had an efficient Navy.

❖ PANDAYA

- **Southern Tamilnadu**
- Great Patrons of **poets and scholars**
- **Pandayas** were **first** mentioned by Megasthenes, Sangam literature mentions them
- A/c to **Megasthenes** Pandaya kingdom was famous for Pearls.
- First know king: **Nedunjeliyan**
- Battle of **Talaiyalanganam**: **Pandaya king defeated combined force of Cheras, cholas and five other chieftains.**

❖ Sangam Literature

- **Agattiyam**: first known book on Tamil Grammar; written by Sage Agathiyar.
- **Tolkappiyam**: Grammar
- **Thirukkural** : Deals with Philosophy
- - Two epics: 1. Silappadikaram 2. Manimekalai

❖ Economic Life:

1. **Agriculture**: The primary occupation of the people was agriculture, with fertile plains, abundant rivers, and a favourable monsoon climate supporting the cultivation of crops like rice, millets, pulses, sugarcane, and cotton.
2. **Trade and Commerce**: Flourishing trade links with the Roman Empire, Southeast Asia, and East Africa were established. Major ports like Muziris and Arikamedu facilitated maritime trade.
3. **Urbanisation**: The growth of urban centres, such as Madurai and Uraiyur, contributed to economic prosperity and cultural exchange

❖ Gupta Dynasty (240 CE - 550 CE)

- **Fall of Mauryan Empire**:- rise of regional kingdoms like Satvahanas in Deccan, Kushans in the north; on the ruins of Kushans, emerged Gupta Empire.
- **Guptas** were possibly the feudatories of the **Kushans**, their earlier empire was on the fertile plain of Gangetic basin.
- This age is known as **Golden Age or Classical Age**

❖ Order of Kings:

- **Srigupta- Ghatotkacha- Chandragupta I- Samudragupta - Chandragupta II - Kumaragupta I - Skandagupta**

❖ Sri Gupta

- Founder of **Gupta Dynasty**; used the title of Maharaja

❖ Ghatotkacha

- Adopted title of Maharaja

❖ Chandragupta I

- First important King of Gupta dynasty
- Adopted the title of **Maharajadhiraja** (king of Kings)
- Empire included parts of Modern Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, and Bengal; capital: **Patliputra**
- Married **Kumaradevi**, princess of **Lichchhavi** clan of Nepal.

❖ Samudragupta

- Expansion of empire to a **great extent**
- Follower of **God Vishnu**
- AKA Lichchhavi- dauhitra in **Allahabad Pillar Inscription** (Prayag Prashasti) by Harisena.
- court language: **Sanskrit**
- Performed Ashvamedha **Yajna**
- A/c to Chinese records, he allowed **Meghavarman** (king of Ceylon) to build a monastery in Bodhgaya.

❖ Chandragupta II

- **Ramgupta** succeeded **Samudragupta**; **Saka ruler** attacked him & defeated him. **Ramgupta** made peace by surrendering his wife **Dhruvadevi**; **Chandragupta II** was infuriated by this, he defeated **Saka ruler**, killed his brother **Ramgupta** and married **Dhruvadevi**.
- Married **Kubernaga**
- Married his daughter **Prabhavati** to **vakataka** king **Rudrasen II**
- Known as **Vikramaditya**
- **Nine jewels** in his court

Name	Designation	Important Works
Kalidasa	Poet and Playwright	Abhijnanasakuntalam (The Recognition of Shakuntala), Raghuvamsha , Meghaduta , Kumārasambhava
Varahamihira	Astronomer and Astrologer	Panchasiddhantika (Five Astronomical Canons), Brihat Samhita , Brihat Jataka

Amarasimha	Lexicographer	Amarakosha (A Sanskrit Thesaurus)
Dhanvantari	Physician	Dhanvantari Nighantu (Ayurvedic Pharmacopoeia)
Vararuchi	Grammerian	Prakrita Prakasa, grammer of Prakrit language

Shanku, Kahapanaka, Vetala Bhatta, and Ghatakarapara

❖ Kumaragupta I

- Known as **Maharajadhiraja, Paramadvaita, and Paramabhattaraka**
- Founded **Nalanda university**
- performed **Asvamedha Yajna**

❖ Skandagupta

- **defeated Hunas** and **repulsed them successfully**

❖ Gupta Administration

- **King is the head of state**
- **Decentralised administration**

- Clearly defined rule of succession
- Empire divided into **Bhukti**, **bhukti** into **vishyas**, **vishyas** into **vithis**, **Vithis** into **gram**
- **Army**: largely dependent on infantry archers; military organisation: **feudal in nature**
- **Judiciary**: most developed during ancient time, clear demarcation of Civil & Criminal Law
- Revenue came from Agriculture (**1/6th of the produce**)

❖ Society

- divided into **four Varnas**- **Brahamans**, **Kshatriyas**, **Vaishyas**, **Shudras**
- Economic and social status of Shudras & women improved a bit but **higher class women** had no access to **independent** sources of livelihood.
- **Male dominating society**, **widow remarriage was allowed**

❖ Art & Craft

- **Sultanganj, Bihar**- 2m high Bronze Image of Buddha (Mathura school of Art)
- **Vishunu sculptures in Udayagiri rock-cut cave**
- **Dhamek Stupa at Sarnath**
- **Buddhist cave in Ajanta**
- **Dasavatara Temple in Deogarh**

❖ Literature

- **Sanskrit** was the official language
- This age saw rise of various Prakrit forms- **Suraseni in Mathura**, **Ardha-Magadhi in Awadh**, etc
- **Siddhasena** laid the foundation of logic among the **Jainas**.
- **Arya Deva** and **Arya Asanga** were most notable **Buddhist writers**

- **Chandrogomia** composed a book on Grammar named Chandra Vyakaranam.

❖ Reason for Decline

- **Huna invasion**
- Gradual **decline** in Economic prosperity
- Decentralised administration
- **Rise of Feudatories**
- **Weak successors**

❖ Comparison between Mauryan and Gupta Empire

Aspect	Mauryan Empire	Gupta Empire	Similarities
Geographical Location	Covered a larger extent of the Indian subcontinent, including present-day India, Pakistan,	Primarily centred in northern and central India	Both empires were centred in the Indian subcontinent.

	Bangladesh, and Afghanistan		
Administration	Centralised administration with a highly organised bureaucracy	Decentralised administration with regional and local governance	Both empires had administrative systems to govern their territories.
Emperors	Chandragupta Maurya, Ashoka the Great, Bindusara, etc.	Chandragupta I, Samudragupta, Chandragupta II, etc.	Shared the name "Chandragupta" among their emperors.
Economy	Thriving trade and commerce, extensive road	Flourishing trade and commerce,	Both empires had robust economies with a focus on

	networks, taxation system	development of guilds, gold coins	trade and commerce.
Religion	Ashoka promoted Buddhism; religious tolerance prevailed	Religious tolerance; revival of Hinduism as the dominant religion	Both empires exhibited religious tolerance and accommodated multiple faiths.
Literature	Ashoka's inscriptions in Prakrit language	Rich Sanskrit literature, including plays, poetry, and scientific texts	Both empires contributed to the development of literature in ancient India.

Art and Architecture	Pillars with inscriptions, rock-cut caves, stupas, and palace complexes	Elaborate temple architecture, sculptures, and Ajanta Caves	Both empires left a significant architectural legacy and patronised the arts.
Decline	Internal conflicts, external invasions, and economic decline	Invasion of Hunas (White Huns), regional fragmentation, and weak rulers	Both empires faced challenges such as invasions and internal conflicts that led to their decline.

❖ Post- Gupta Era

- with the **decline of Gupta empire** several small political powers emerged

In North India

1. The Maitrakas
2. The Maukharis
3. The Gaudas

4. The Hunas
5. Pushyabhutis of Thanesar

In south India

1. Ikshvakus
2. Chalukyas of Badami
3. Pallavas of Kanchi
4. The Kadamba Kingdom
5. The Kalabhras

❖ Pushyabhuti Dynasty

- Feudatories of the Guptas
- AKA Vardhana Dynasty
- **Prabhakarvardhan** was the fourth king of the dynasty, who made the dynasty powerful and strong. **Defeated Hunas**
- **Rajavardhana** succeeded him but was murdered by **Shashanka**. Thus **Harshavardhana** (Harsha) Became **king of Thanesar**
- **Hsuan Tsang** visited India and wrote **Si-Yu-Ki**
- Banabhatta (Court poet of Harsha) wrote **Harshacharita**
- **Harsha** himself was **a great scholar and poet**, wrote **Nagananda, Ratnavali, and Priyadarshika**
- followed Tolerant religious philosophy; followed Shaivism but later converted to **Mahayana Buddhism**
- Administration became **Feudal and decentralised**
- Organised Religious assemblies in the **5th** year of his reign at Prayaga, convened an assembly at **kannauj** to honour **Husan Tsang**
- A/c to Hsuan Tsang Kannauj has become **important city replacing Patliputra**

Miscellaneous

1. POTTERY OF DIFFERENT CULTURES

Culture	Period	Pottery Types
Mehrgarh Culture	7000-2600 BCE	Red Ware, Black-on-Red Ware
Indus Valley Civilization	2600-1900 BCE	Painted Grey Ware, Black Polished Ware
Ochre Coloured Pottery Culture	2000-1500 BCE	Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP)
Early Iron Age Cultures	1200-600 BCE	Northern Black Polished Ware, Painted Grey Ware (PGW)

Megalithic Cultures	1000-300 BCE	Black and Red Ware, Red Ware
Mesolithic Cultures	10000- 2000 BCE	Microlithic tools, No specific pottery tradition
Jorwe Culture	1400-700 BCE	Jorwe Ware (Reddish-brown pottery)
Malwa Culture	1500-500 BCE	Malwa Ware (Red and black pottery)
Ahar-Banas Culture	2500-1500 BCE	Ahar-Banas Ware (Red and black pottery)
Hakra Ware Culture	3800-3200 BCE	Hakra Ware (Plain and painted pottery)

Bagor Culture		9000-4800 BCE	Bagor Ware (Red and black pottery)
Sothi-Siswal Culture	4600- 3500 BCE	Sothi-Siswal Ware (Red and black pottery)	



❖ GUPTA ART & ARCHITECTURE

1. Temple Architecture:

- Gupta temple architecture laid the foundation for the **Nagara style**, which became dominant in later periods.
- **Temples** were generally constructed using **stone, and brick** was used for smaller shrines.
- The temples were **square or rectangular** in plan, with a sanctum at the centre and an entrance **porch (mandapa)** leading to the sanctum.
- Elaborate doorways and intricately carved pillars were common features.

2. Sculpture:

- Gupta sculptures were characterised by their **grace, naturalism, and idealisation of human forms**.
- The **art** of stone carving reached its zenith during this period, with highly skilled craftsmen producing exquisite sculptures.
- **Buddha and Bodhisattva** figures were prevalent, often depicted in various postures like the seated **Buddha**, standing **Buddha**, and reclining **Buddha**.

3. Buddha Images:

- The **Gupta period** saw a shift from **aniconic** representations of **Buddha** to anthropomorphic images of the **Buddha**.

- **Buddha** statues were made of **stone or bronze**, showcasing the Buddha in a calm and meditative state with elongated earlobes and a serene smile.

4. Wall Paintings:

- Wall paintings adorned the walls of temples and caves.
- Fresco paintings showcased scenes from the **Jataka** tales (stories of Buddha's previous lives) and mythological narratives.

5. Cave Architecture:

- The Gupta period witnessed the continuation of rock-cut architecture, which began in earlier centuries.
- The **Udayagiri and Khandagiri** caves in Odisha are prime examples of Gupta cave architecture, featuring intricately carved facades and pillared halls.

6. Ajanta Caves:

- The **Ajanta Caves**, dating back to the Gupta period, are one of the most remarkable achievements of **Indian art**.
- These caves are renowned for their exceptional rock-cut **Buddhist monuments**, including monastic complexes and prayer halls.
- The caves also house exquisite mural paintings depicting the life and teachings of Buddha.

7. Coinage Art:

- **Gupta coins** were minted with **high-quality artwork**, showcasing **portraits of kings, deities, and various symbols**.
- The use of **gold coins** during the Gupta period exemplified the empire's economic prosperity.

8. Metalwork:

- Gupta artisans excelled in metalworking, crafting intricate bronze figurines and statues.
- The famous **Nataraja statue**, depicting Shiva as the **cosmic dancer**, is an iconic example of **Gupta metalwork**.

Mughal Art and Architecture

The **Mughal Empire** (c. 1526 CE - c. 1857 CE) was a significant period in Indian history marked by the confluence of Persian, Islamic, and indigenous **Indian artistic traditions**. **Mughal art and architecture**, characterised by grandeur, opulence, and attention to detail, left an indelible mark on India's cultural landscape.

1. Indo-Islamic Architecture:

- Mughal architecture combined elements of **Islamic** and **Indian** architectural styles, creating a unique **Indo-Islamic** fusion.
- The use of **red sandstone and marble**, intricate carvings, and calligraphy were prominent features.
- **Domes, minarets**, and arches were common architectural elements.

2. Mughal Gardens:

- The Mughals introduced the concept of **Charbagh**, a **four-part garden layout**, into India.
- These gardens were laid out in a **square or rectangular shape** and featured **water channels, fountains, and lush greenery**.
- Famous examples include the **Shalimar Bagh** in Srinagar and the **Mehtab Bagh** in Agra.

3. Forts and Palaces:

- **Mughal forts**, such as the **Red Fort in Delhi and Agra Fort**, were massive structures built for **defensive and administrative purposes**.
- Palaces within these forts showcased exquisite craftsmanship and luxurious living spaces.

4. Taj Mahal:

- **The Taj Mahal**, built by Emperor **Shah Jahan**, is the most iconic monument of Mughal architecture and a **UNESCO World Heritage Site**.
- This marble mausoleum was constructed in memory of Emperor **Shah Jahan's wife, Mumtaz Mahal**.
- The Taj Mahal's **symmetrical design**, intricate marble inlays, and the central dome are renowned worldwide.

5. Humayun's Tomb:

- **Humayun's Tomb** in Delhi is one of the earliest examples of **Mughal architecture in India**.

- It served as a **prototype** for later Mughal architectural wonders, including the Taj Mahal.

6. Jama Masjid:

- The **Jama Masjid** in **Delhi** is one of the largest and most beautiful mosques in India.
- It boasts a massive courtyard, **three domes, and two minarets.**

7. Miniature Paintings:

- Mughal miniature paintings were highly refined, characterized by intricate detailing and vibrant colours.
- Themes included portraits of emperors, scenes from the royal court, religious events, and literary works.
- Notable artists during this period included **Basawan, Daswanth, and Mansur.**

8. Calligraphy:

- **Persian** and **Arabic** calligraphy adorned the walls and facades of Mughal buildings.
- Quranic **verses** and **praise** for the emperor were common inscriptions.

9. Inlay Work:

- **Pietra dura**, or **marble inlay work**, was extensively used in Mughal architecture.

- Precious and semi-precious stones were inlaid into marble surfaces to create intricate floral and geometric patterns.

10. Literature and Manuscripts:

- The Mughal court patronized fine calligraphy and illustrated manuscripts.
- Illustrations and miniatures were made for books and manuscripts, showcasing refined artistic skills

Difference Between Nagara and Dravida Style Of Temple Architecture		
Area Of Differentiation	Nagara Style	Dravida Style
Location	Temples located in Northern India are listed as Nagara style.	Temples located in Southern India are listed as Dravida style.
Main temples spire	Nagara style of architecture has multiple shikharas.	Dravida style has one single shikhara.
Mandapa Towers	In the Nagara style, there are multiple Towers.	In Dravida style, it is always a single Tower.
Central Tower	In Nagara style, the central tower is curvilinear in shape.	In Dravida style, the central tower is shaped like a pyramid.
Boundaries and deities	Nagara style does not give much importance to the temple boundaries, and the deities are kept inside.	In this style, the temple boundaries are given high importance, and the deities are kept outside.
 		
Similarities		
• Both the Dravida and the Nagara styles of architecture were developed with the help of their respective dynasty. • In both the styles of architecture, the buildings were heavily engraved, and was full of sculptures. • Both the Nagara style of architecture and the Dravidian architecture style speak volumes about the literature and society of the era.		

**Suno, 5 saal baad ye kuch matter nahi krega
jin cheejon me abhi waqt derhe... webseries
kahin nahi jayegi, Wo utni hi khubsurat
rhegi 5 saal bad bhi, koi kahi nahi jayega, aur
tum nahi padhoge to tum bhi kahin ni jaoge
yi reh jaoge. Yahi rehna hai? Nahi na? To
padhte kaahe ni? Roj khud ko smjha dete ho
Koi na koi bahana,haina?**



**Kbhi socha hai mummy ko kitni khushi hogi
dusro ko btane me ki mera beta/beti afsar
hai? Wo khushi tumare babu shona ya ye din
raat reel scroll krke ni milne wali, niklo be in
sb se..aur kuch ban jao..Your family deserve
all the happiness..Sirf tumari mehnat degi
unhe.. Smj jao yar.**